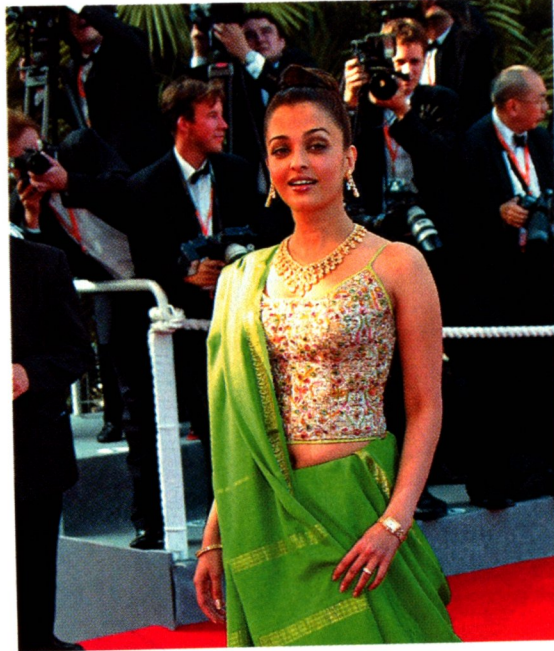
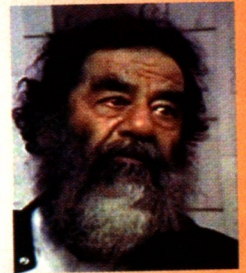




"I'LL WORK TO HEAR THE ANTHEM ON THE PODIUM."

With that singular thought, Anju Bobby George pushed herself and entered the history books, winning a bronze medal in long jump at the Paris World Athletics Championships. She was the first Indian to win a medal at the event. Aishwarya Rai scored a win of sorts too, on an altogether different turf. Domestic fashionistas notwithstanding, the French loved her when she went to the Cannes Film Festival as the first Indian actor on the jury. Rai rubbed shoulders with international celebrities and for a time threatened to take Bollywood global.

● On December 12, Saddam Hussein's reign came to an end after he was captured at a farmhouse near his hometown, Tikrit. Hussein, as he emerged from his underground hiding-place, was bearded and dishevelled, a shadow of his fearsome former self. After capture, Hussein was put on a speedy trial on charges



of crimes against humanity. With his conviction US President George Bush hoped to gain support for his War Against Terror, both at home and abroad.

POWER PLAY Atal Bihari Vajpayee



The Gujarat riots, though they shook the foundation of India's deep-rooted secularism, couldn't come in Atal Bihari Vajpayee's way in restoring peace within the BJP. His visit to China in June led to the establishment of a Joint Study Group for economic cooperation. Vajpayee was able to facilitate ceasefire in Kashmir, free prisoners, resume bus and rail travel and break down barriers on trade between India and Pakistan. And at home, he gave the economy the booster shot it needed to step up into the world.

1,560

is the number of kilometers that was marked to be added to the National Highway network, taking the total kilometers to 3,477 since the year 2000. The World Bank decided to invest \$1 billion (Rs 4,500 crore) in the country's transport sector in the same year.